

The Accessible Website Checklist

Why Accessibility Matters

1 in 5 people in the UK has a disability. An accessible website serves more customers, performs better in search, and reflects the values that most craft businesses stand for. Most accessibility improvements are simple to make.

Text and Readability

- ☐ Body text is at least 16px
- ☐ Line height is at least 1.5
- ☐ Text colour has sufficient contrast against background (check: webaim.org/resources/contrastchecker)
- ☐ No text is placed directly on a busy photograph without a dark overlay
- ☐ Fonts are legible — avoid script or decorative fonts for body text
- ☐ Paragraphs are no wider than 75 characters (use max-width)

Images

- ☐ Every image has an alt text description
- ☐ Alt text describes what the image shows — not "image" or the filename
- ☐ Decorative images have empty alt text (alt="")
- ☐ Product images show the product clearly without misleading colour

Navigation

- ☐ All pages are reachable from the main navigation
- ☐ Navigation links clearly describe where they go
- ☐ The site works with keyboard navigation (Tab key)
- ☐ Current page is indicated in the navigation
- ☐ Skip to main content link exists (helpful for screen readers)

Forms and Buttons

- ☐ All form fields have visible labels
- ☐ Buttons describe their action ("Add to basket" not "Click here")

- [] Error messages explain what went wrong and how to fix it

Mobile

- [] Site works on mobile without horizontal scrolling
- [] Text is readable without zooming
- [] Buttons are large enough to tap with a finger

Free Testing Tools

WAVE (wave.webaim.org) — scan any URL for accessibility issues

Lighthouse (built into Chrome DevTools) — accessibility audit

Colour Contrast Analyser — check text/background contrast